

Move-Out Cleaning SOP

The Cleaning CEO Blueprint — 100% Cleaner Academy

Service type: Vacant home turnover for landlord, realtor, or seller

Target home: Empty — no furniture, no personal belongings

Price reference: \$350–\$500+ (size and condition dependent)

Time target: 5–8 hours (solo) | 4–6 hours (2-person team)

Purpose

Deliver a **move-in ready** empty home. Every room, cabinet, closet, and appliance must pass a white-glove inspection. This is the highest-detail residential service you offer.

Pre-Job Requirements

Confirm before booking:

- ☐ Home is 100% vacant (no furniture, boxes, or stored items)
- ☐ Utilities are ON (water, electricity, HVAC)
- ☐ Scope includes all appliances, cabinets, closets, and garage (if applicable)
- ☐ Keys or lockbox access confirmed
- ☐ Photos required for landlord/realtor sign-off

Do NOT start if belongings remain — charge a partial clean or reschedule.

Supplies Checklist

Full deep clean kit, plus:

- ☐ Oven cleaner + heavy degreaser
- ☐ Refrigerator cleaner (baking soda solution or approved product)
- ☐ Cabinet shelf liner remover / adhesive remover
- ☐ Step stool and flashlight (inside cabinets, closets)
- ☐ Vacuum with hose, crevice, and upholstery tools
- ☐ Steam cleaner (optional — bathrooms, tile)

- ☐ Razor scraper (stove glass, sticker residue — test first)
- ☐ Multiple trash bags (clients often leave debris)
- ☐ Extension duster
- ☐ Grout brush, toilet brush, detail brushes

Move-Out Room Order

Work top to bottom, back of house to front, wet areas with dwell time first.

Order	Area	Time Target
1	Kitchen — full detail + appliances	90–120 min
2	All bathrooms — full detail	45–60 min each
3	All bedrooms + closets (inside/out)	30–40 min each
4	Living, dining, office, hallways	30 min each
5	Laundry room / mudroom	20–30 min
6	Garage (if in scope) — sweep, cobwebs	20–30 min
7	Interior windows + sills + tracks	45–60 min
8	Baseboards, doors, switch plates — whole home	45 min
9	All floors — vacuum edges, mop	45–60 min
10	Final white-glove walk-through + photos	20 min

Kitchen — Move-Out Standard

Cabinets & Drawers

- ☐ Empty check — remove any leftover items to trash (document if excessive)
- ☐ Wipe inside every shelf, drawer, and door panel
- ☐ Clean handles, hinges, and frame edges
- ☐ Remove shelf liner if peeling; wipe adhesive residue

Appliances

- ☐ **Refrigerator:** Remove shelves/drawers, wash, wipe interior walls, clean exterior and handles, pull forward and clean floor underneath if accessible
- ☐ **Oven:** Remove racks, degrease interior, clean glass door inside/out, wipe stovetop and control panel
- ☐ **Microwave:** Clean interior and exterior
- ☐ **Dishwasher:** Wipe interior, filter area, door edges, exterior
- ☐ **Range hood:** Degrease filter (if removable and in scope) and exterior

Surfaces

- ☐ Degrease backsplash and all counter surfaces
- ☐ Clean sink, faucet, and disposal splash area
- ☐ Wipe all cabinet fronts
- ☐ Clean inside of pantry/closet if present

Full procedure: see Kitchen SOP

Bathroom — Move-Out Standard

- ☐ Scrub tub/shower — remove all soap scum and mildew stains
- ☐ Grout detail where discolored
- ☐ Toilet: inside bowl, tank exterior, seat, base, behind toilet, floor bolts
- ☐ Vanity: inside drawers and cabinets (empty), counter, sink, faucet
- ☐ Mirror, light fixtures, exhaust fan cover (exterior wipe)
- ☐ Towel bars, toilet paper holder, hooks
- ☐ Floor: sweep, mop, edges

Full procedure: see Bathroom SOP

Bedrooms & Closets

- ☐ Wipe inside all closets — shelves, rods, floor, doors inside/out
- ☐ Clean closet tracks and door frames
- ☐ Wipe all walls for scuffs (magic eraser — test first)
- ☐ Dust ceiling fan, vents, light fixtures
- ☐ Clean window sills and tracks

- ☐ Baseboards and door frames
 - ☐ Vacuum/mop floor including closet floors
-

Living Areas & Hallways

- ☐ All vents and returns wiped
 - ☐ Light fixtures and ceiling fans dusted
 - ☐ Fireplace surround wiped (no chimney work)
 - ☐ All interior doors wiped both sides + frames
 - ☐ Switch plates and outlet covers wiped
 - ☐ Stair rails and spindles
 - ☐ Baseboards throughout
-

Laundry Room

- ☐ Wipe washer and dryer exterior
 - ☐ Clean inside washer door gasket (front-load)
 - ☐ Wipe shelves, sink, and counter
 - ☐ Sweep and mop floor
 - ☐ Clean lint trap area exterior
-

Quality Standards (Landlord/Realtor Pass)

- ☐ Open any cabinet — no crumbs, dust, or sticky residue
 - ☐ Open oven and fridge — no odor, no grease, shelves reinstalled
 - ☐ Bathrooms pass a "would I move in?" test
 - ☐ Closets are empty, wiped, and floor is clean
 - ☐ All floors vacuumed at edges and mopped
 - ☐ No cobwebs, no dust on fans/vents
 - ☐ Photos document kitchen, each bath, and main living areas
-

Do NOT (Move-Out)

- ❌ Clean a partially occupied home at move-out price
 - ❌ Dispose of large abandoned items without written approval
 - ❌ Paint, patch walls, or repair fixtures — cleaning only
 - ❌ Remove permanent fixtures or appliance parts you can't reinstall
 - ❌ Guarantee mold remediation or pest removal
 - ❌ Leave wet cabinets closed — air dry before closing doors
 - ❌ Skip the fridge pull-out — landlords always check
-

Documentation Checklist

- ☐ Before photos (if access allows pre-clean)
 - ☐ After photos: kitchen (oven/fridge open), each bathroom, master closet, living area
 - ☐ Note any damage, missing hardware, or issues beyond cleaning scope
 - ☐ Send completion report to property manager within 2 hours
-

100% Cleaner — Move-out cleans win property manager contracts.